

Apollo, to David Rice

Chief AI Officer, HSBC. Fifteen to twenty minutes, five beats, twelve plot points. One live build, one live graph, no deck.

PRESENTED BY

Dave Ewen

CARDS PREPARED

2026-09-11

What you will see in the next sixteen minutes

#	MINS	CLOCK	PLOT POINT	ON SCREEN
B1	2:00	0:00–2:00	INTRO	
01	1:00	0:00–1:00	Why I am here, in one sentence	Title card
02	1:00	1:00–2:00	What you will see in the next sixteen minutes	The strip above
B2	4:00	2:00–6:00	GOAL · PRACTICAL BENEFITS · PREDICTED KPIS	
03	1:30	2:00–3:30	The problem, in his metaphor	Title card — metaphor spoken, no diagram
04	1:00	3:30–4:30	The claim: two measured gains, stacked — and the hypothesis the pilot tests	Number card — 15% · 47% · 6 mo → 6 wk?
05	1:30	4:30–6:00	The only measured before-and-after we own	COLDRUN-258-2026-09-08-v5
B3	5:30	6:00–11:30	RUN THE DEMO — THE FROZEN PROMPT, COLD	
06	0:30	6:00–6:30	The prompt goes in, unedited	VS Code, Apollo-Spider v1.0.13
07	2:00	6:30–8:30	Dead air A — what inspired it	The build scrolling. Do not switch away.
08	1:30	8:30–10:00	Dead air B — how it developed	Timeline card, if the build is still running
09	1:30	10:00–11:30	The page lands. Drive it.	The generated dashboard.html, light theme
B4	4:30	11:30–16:00	THE SYSTEM, SIMPLY	
10	1:30	11:30–13:00	Four moving parts, no black box	Four-part diagram
11	3:00	13:00–16:00	The knowledge graph — dig, scrub, trace, and ask it why	notes/_KG-EXPLORER.html v1.10
B5	2:00	16:00–18:00	AMBITION · REQUIREMENTS · THE ASK	
12	2:00	16:00–18:00	Where it goes, what it needs, what I am asking for	The ask card, then silence
	18:00		Stated sum. Band 15–20. Two minutes of deliberate slack.	

Source [notes/_RUN-OF-SHOW-david-rice-2026-09-10-v1.html](#) — “The strip — one screen”

The parts bin

An assembly line is only as fast as its parts bin — and our designers have been hand-machining the gearbox every time a car comes down the line.

On screen Title card only. The metaphor is spoken — no diagram.

Source Run of show, plot point 03 (filled #268, Dave's words)

15%

HSBC's own

Published coding-time efficiency,
20,000+ developers.

47%

IBM Carbon, no AI

Same form, 4.2 h → 2.0 h with a
design system. The library alone.

6 months → 6 weeks?

Hypothesis, measured by the pilot

Not a result. "How do you know six
weeks?" — "I don't. That is K1."

— PLOT POINT 05 · THE ONLY MEASURED BEFORE-AND-AFTER WE OWN

BEFORE — 8 SEPTEMBER, FIRST RUN

2

Visually rich

2

Full

0

Persistent

2

Interactive



AFTER — SAME DAY, FIFTH BLIND RUN

3

Visually rich

3

Full

3

Persistent

2

Interactive

Four axes — visually rich, full, persistent, interactive — nought to three each. Five blind runs in one day, each one finding a real defect. Self-scored, and every point verified by driving the page in a browser, not by reading the source.

— PLOT POINT 05 · PREDICTED KPIS — FIVE, EACH WITH AN EXTERNAL BASELINE

	NAME	BASELINE	TARGET ON THE FIRST LIVE PROJECT
K1	Time to first gated screen	Sparkbox 4.2 h → 2.0 h	Same-day for a multi-screen flow — the only KPI the demo produces live
K2	Library reuse rate	GitClear: AI duplication up 8×	≥80% of rendered UI from gated components
K3	Change-failure rate	DORA 2025: AI adoption correlates with worse stability	No worse than the team's pre-AI rate — explicitly not an improvement
K4	Research-analysis cycle time	JMIR 2024: 492 → 15 min, 71–90% consistency	≥70% on the analysis step; fieldwork hours unchanged and reported separately
K5	Coding-time efficiency	HSBC's own 15%	Match it on the front-end build. Promise no more.

— BEAT 3 · RUN THE DEMO

Live build

v1.0.13, the frozen prompt, cold. One prompt, one compliant dashboard, nothing edited.

— SWITCH TO VS CODE

On screen VS Code, Apollo-Spider v1.0.13 installed — then the generated dashboard.html, light theme

— BEAT 4 · THE SYSTEM, SIMPLY

Four moving parts. No black box.

Live graph — 2,837 nodes · 4,902 edges.

— SWITCH TO THE KG EXPLORER

DRAFT — THE ASK SLOT IS DAVE'S AND IS NOT RULED

One live project, sponsored — six weeks on the clock, K1–K5 measured against your own fifteen percent. If it doesn't beat your number, you've lost six weeks. If it does, you own the stack.

Apollo

2,837 nodes · 4,902 edges